

inch) and 16 cm (6.3 inch) screen size. So we don't mind the competition within the same family. But having said that, I believe that the screen size is the big differentiator in the smart devices category. Right from 7.6 cm (3 inch) to 16 cm (6.3 inch), there are different consumers who want different screen sizes. There are youngsters and enterprise people who prefer large devices, which help them for their entertainment on-the-go or for official purposes, respectively. The differentiator is that if they want to use only one device, they go for something like a 14.7 cm (5.8-inch) device, because they can enjoy both functionalities on the same product. But there are some people who like carrying a smaller phone along with a tab for other purposes. As market leaders, we want to make sure that we give all the options to the customers.

Q: Samsung Galaxy Tab 2 was one of the most successful tablets in the Indian market. What are your expectations with Tab 3 and how do you plan to position it?

Yes, Galaxy Tab 2 was one of the most successful products that we have introduced and we hold a 62 per cent market share, in terms of value, with this device. We are hoping that with Tab 3, we will take that even further and grow the market even faster. As a part of providing value to the customer, we are offering Rs 20,000 worth of free content with Tab 3. So a user is buying a device worth Rs 17,000 and is getting content worth Rs 20,000 for free.

Q: Do you consider it a threat when Google announces a version of your device, like Samsung Galaxy S4, with stock Android? Those devices are being well-received because people actually want pure Android. Does that mean consumers do not want manufacturers' modified software on their devices? That they want great hardware with pure Android?

There are different types of customers with different preferences. We believe that we have to address a very large segment of the market. That is why we launch products that appeal to different segments, which require a smartphone for as low as Rs 5000, and not just to the niche audiences like techies. We firmly believe that we have to reach out to a person who may not have a technological bent of mind but can operate our devices with ease. Customers want a good UI and experience with great hardware. That is what Samsung has perfected over the years. This is why the Galaxy series is a market leader in many countries across the globe, including India. So, yes, there will be some versions that some customers may like but looking at the overall market, I think we are doing a reasonably good job with our version of Android. Also, unlike in any other industry, this is one industry where hardware and software together make the magic happen. We do lots of research prior to creating software. We spend 8 per cent of our overall revenue on R&D just to perfect that art of making the hardware and the software work together, and I believe that is a very important differentiator for us.

The second and the most important part of the game is selling the products. To sell a large number of these

exciting devices, you require skills in retailing and after-sales service. Samsung has developed these skills in a robust way over the last 3-4 years.

Q: Why does Samsung feel the need to tweak the stock Android?

There is a lot of layering that we like to do in the software to enhance the experience, which is based on the feedback that we get from our customers. Second, we have established a benchmark with our TouchWiz UI. What we have seen is that people switching from one Samsung device to the other want that TouchWiz experience to be with them. That is also one big reason why we want to have the modifications and make our customers comfortable with the technology.

Q: One of the persistent complaints against the Galaxy Series of devices is that they come with the same look and design. We see only the screen sizes changing, and you claim that the magic is between the hardware and the software. We agree that the magic is there, but having the same design again is surely not a good idea. When do we see a new or different design in the Galaxy series?

Let me answer this with an example. People talk about Galaxy S3 and Galaxy S4 sporting the same look. If you keep the two devices together, Galaxy S4 is much slimmer and a little larger in screen size as compared to the S3. So, there's a big design change that has happened in between the two devices. A lot of work is done in bringing about a slimmer device. So I would say that we are constantly working to evolve the design.

Also, we differentiate between the devices on various levels. While you may not see a dramatic change in the design elements of a device, but there are other factors which have evolved a lot, like the S4 cover for example. It is a simple and user friendly innovation. The attach rate, which means the number of people who buy the S4 cover along with the device, compared to that of S3, is considerably higher, so much so that we have started giving it along with the S4, just because it is an important differentiator. Having said that, I would like to reiterate that Samsung as a company has succeeded because we listen to the consumer and we take this feedback as a guide for our future devices.

Q: For the free apps that you are offering with Samsung's Galaxy Tab 3, did you conduct some developers' engagement programme to develop apps for the device?

We have a specialised content development team that has tie-ups with developers, who create content for our devices. We reach out to them through forums, through Google and also directly, and engage them to work with us.

Q: Market experts opine that Samsung Galaxy S4 cannot do as well as Samsung S3. What do you think?

I would differ on that. Samsung Galaxy S4 is doing